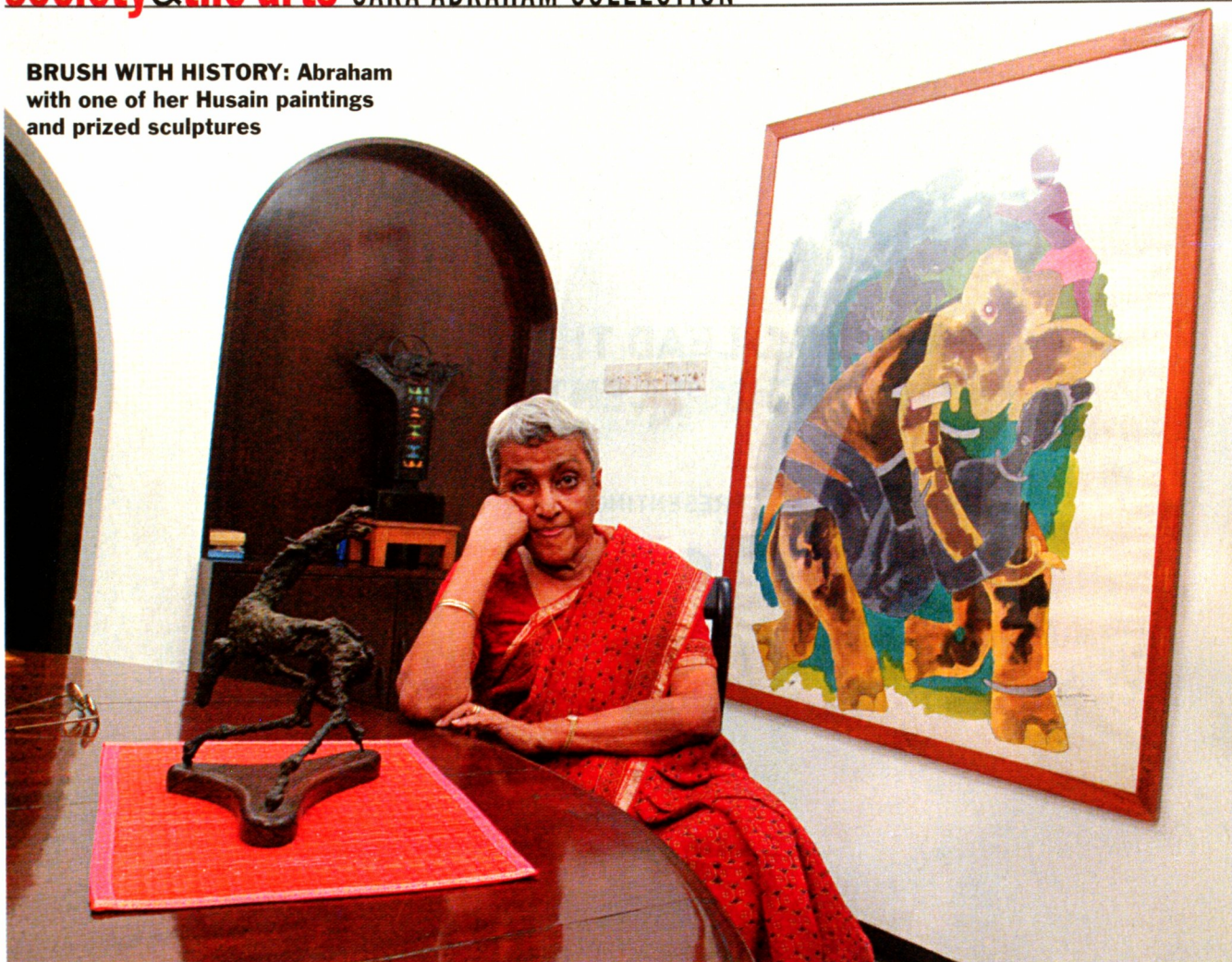


BRUSH WITH HISTORY: Abraham with one of her Husain paintings and prized sculptures



Photographs by H.K. RAJASHEKAR

A TRIBUTE AND A RARE TREAT

The grand dame of Indian contemporary art turns 80 and a celebration-cum-tribute allows art lovers a rare look at her personal collection of over 200 paintings by giants of Indian art

■ By Nirmala Ravindran

Somnath Hore canvas catches the eye as you walk in, preceding several works by K. Ramanujam. The sketches by F.N. Souza belong to another time. For company there is Bikash Bhattacharya, while the rest of the wall space is shared by M.F. Husain, Laxma Goud, Ramkumar, K.G. Subramanyam, Tyeb Mehta, and A. Ramachandran. To be in the company



HUES: (left) Bhattacharya's Abraham family; Lotus Pond by Ramachandran of such giants, and all at the same time, can be an intimidating experience, but not for Sara Abraham, who continues to be good friends with the entire generation of artists that she grew up with. "It's what I like best, to look at my collection every single day," says

